

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 842

By Jones J

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Larry Bushart of
Henderson County.

WHEREAS, on September 21, 2025, in the middle of the night, Larry Bushart, a retired police officer with more than three decades of experience, was arrested on false charges due to having posted a pre-existing political meme on social media; and

WHEREAS, according to news reports, Perry County issued a warrant for his arrest and charged him with "threatening mass violence at a school"; and

WHEREAS, handcuffed and put behind bars, Mr. Bushart could not afford his bond, which was set at \$2 million, and he spent the next thirty-seven days in the Perry County jail; as a result of his arrest, he lost his job and missed both his wedding anniversary and the birth of his grandchild; and

WHEREAS, after widespread media coverage of his arrest and incarceration, Larry Bushart was finally released from jail, and all charges were dismissed; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bushart has said, "I spent over three decades in law enforcement, and have the utmost respect for the law. But I also know my rights, and I was arrested for nothing more than refusing to be bullied into censorship"; and

WHEREAS, Larry Bushart is a champion of free speech and was unjustly punished for exercising his First Amendment rights; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bushart has been committed to public safety and ensuring child welfare, both during his time of service and his advocacy after; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bushart's commitment to defending his civil liberties is a commendable act of courage and sacrifice; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend retired law enforcement officer Larry Bushart of Henderson County for his defense of the First Amendment.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.